DAY 2

God Is Still Listening



"The psalmist loves the Lord because He has received his voice and his pleas; he therefore wants to keep calling on Him throughout his life."

PSALM 116:1–2

Some requests remain with us for a long time. You bring them to God when you wake, remember them at work, and mention them again before bed. When circumstances stay the same, the repetition can become painful. The original problem is no longer the only burden; you also wonder whether continuing to pray has any meaning. Being heard seems to depend on seeing a change.

In Psalm 116, the memory of a prayer received sustains the desire to keep seeking the Lord. The passage comes from a real experience of suffering and deliverance. It gives no timetable for every answer, but shows that our relationship with God can be nourished by memory. In a difficult season, remembering care already received keeps the present from occupying the whole story.

Being heard does not mean receiving everything we ask for. That distinction matters: it keeps prayer from becoming a demand and keeps you from blaming every disappointment on supposedly inadequate faith. There are unwanted losses, paths that remain closed, and outcomes we do not understand. None of those experiences, on its own, proves that God has stopped receiving your voice.

Nor do we need to explain suffering quickly with phrases about hidden plans. When someone is hurting, a ready-made answer can deepen loneliness. Sometimes the most faithful response is to admit that we do not know why something happened and remain before God with that question. Trust can coexist with lament. The psalms themselves teach us to ask for help without disguising pain.

Persistent prayer has a place in that honesty. You can say that you are still waiting but are tired. You can admit that you no longer know another way to put the request. There is no need to find new words to make your distress more convincing. The Lord knows what lies behind the repeated sentence: someone you love, an old concern, a hope you fear losing.

As you pray, notice the care available to you. Seeking guidance, accepting help, and making responsible decisions do not diminish trust in God. Someone may be able to walk with you through something you have faced in silence. Prayer does not require refusing human companionship or standing still until you notice an extraordinary sign.

There may be no visible answer today. Even so, you can set aside a few minutes to speak to God without making the moment an assessment of results. Tell Him what is happening, give thanks for the care you can recognize, and allow questions to remain open. Continuing to pray is offering your presence to this relationship. Your voice does not have to be steady to be brought to the Lord.

TO KEEP IN YOUR HEART

Not receiving the answer you hoped for does not make your prayer worthless.

TODAY'S PRAYER

Lord, You know the requests I keep repeating and the weariness that sometimes accompanies my words. Receive my questions too, without my having to hide disappointment. Help me remember the care I have already experienced and recognize the help available today. Give me wisdom to act where I can and patience with what remains uncertain. Keep me from turning prayer into a demand or silence into a verdict against myself. Sustain my desire to keep speaking with You. Amen.